

ITLS 6320 | DESIGN JUSTIFICATION

Maximizing Onboarding & Engagement

A Research-Backed Onboarding & UX Strategy for Alta

Prepared By
Nikaila Bell

Target Audience Alta Leadership,
Engineering & Design

Focus Activation & Retention
Optimization

The word "ALTA" is displayed in a bold, black, sans-serif font, centered within a white rectangular box. The box is framed by a thin, dark green border. The background of the slide features a faint, light blue geometric pattern of overlapping squares and rectangles.

■ Introduction

App Strengths

- Digitizing wardrobe
- AI suggestions
- Outfit planning
- Effortless style

The Problem

- Steep setup and manual digitizing barrier
- High early abandonment
- Premium features hidden

The Need for Guidance

- Structured, step-by-step onboarding walkthrough
- "How-to" blueprint to simplify manual labor
- Clear procedural guide to drive high activation

User Research & Friction Points

✓ User Research Insights

Busy students struggle with initial setup and wardrobe digitizing.

✓ High Early Complexity

Overwhelming first impressions bury premium value and features.

✓ Tedious Labor Barrier

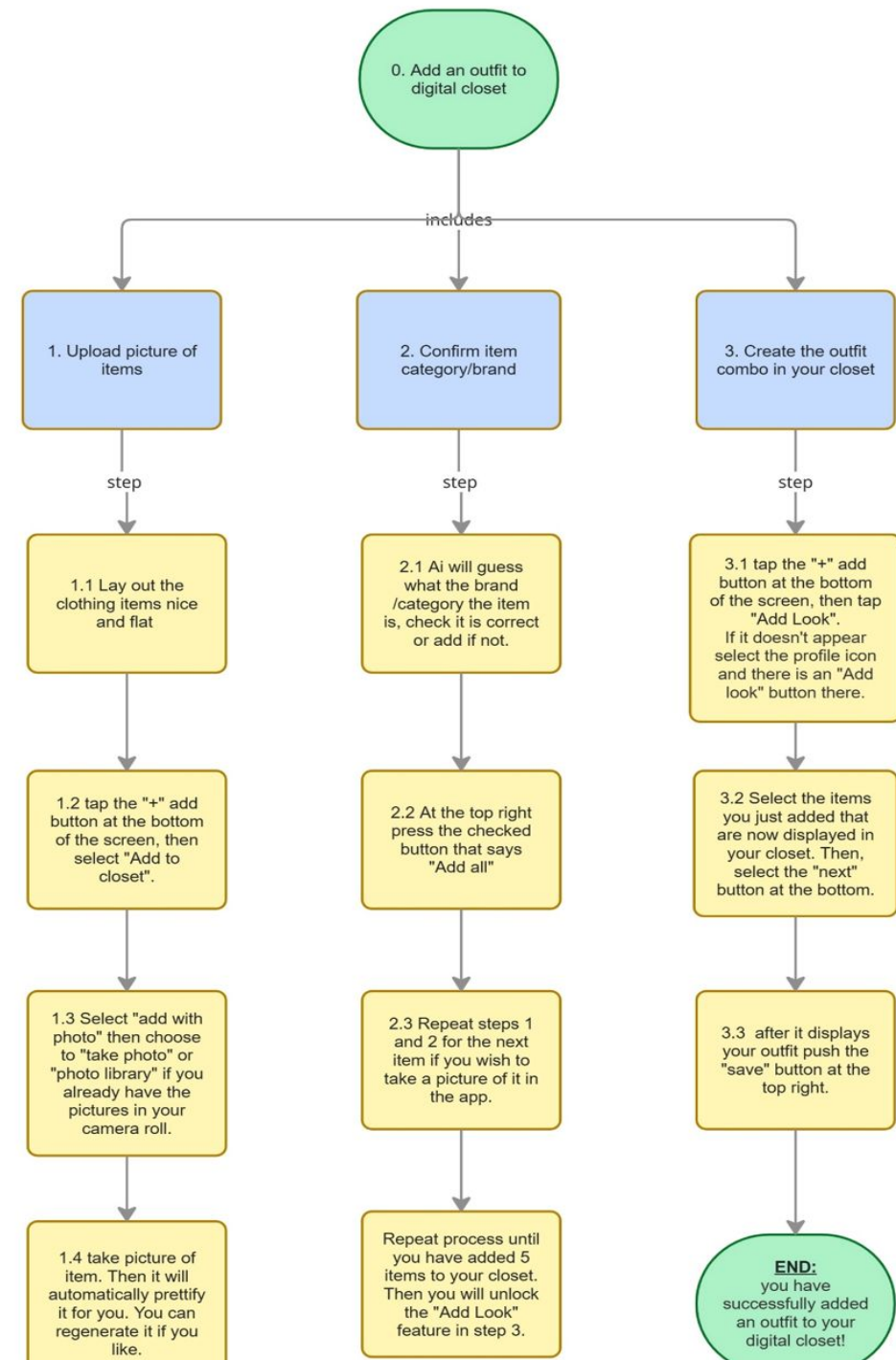
Manual cataloging feels repetitive without clear guidance or rewards.

✓ High Churn Risk

Initial setup friction drives early doubt and rapid app abandonment.

✓ HTA Process Mapping

HTA modeling visualizes user tasks, exposing exact steps where friction can be systematically reduced.



Understanding the User: Empathy Map

Target Audience Profile

Low-Effort, High-Style Dressers (Ages 16-35) — Value self-expression but easily overwhelmed by choice.

What Do They Need?

- **Outsource Curation:** A hands-off tool to automatically plan and coordinate style-forward outfits.
- **Maximize Closet Potential:** Unlocking and styling neglected clothing items effectively.

What Do They See?

- **Forgotten Wardrobe:** Closets packed with once-loved but currently neglected, unstyled garments.
- **Disconnection:** An abundance of physical pieces alongside a feeling of having "nothing to wear."

What Do They Say?

- **"I have nothing to wear"** despite owning an overwhelming abundance of apparel.
- **"I want to keep them"** but feel guilt over a growing collection of completely unworn pieces.

What Do They Do?

- **Repetitive Outfits:** Reverting to the exact same safe, comfortable clothing loops every week.
- **Daily Frustration:** Suffering through high friction and emotional stress during morning routines.

Pains

- **Decision Fatigue:** Mental exhaustion from endless daily styling choices.
- **Cataloging Tax:** Overwhelming friction of manually uploading an entire physical closet.

Gains

- **Effortless Confidence:** Feeling highly inspired, styled, and put together daily.
- **Wardrobe Mastery:** Gaining ultimate organization and total control over closet utility.

The Solution: Interactive Onboarding Experience

Bespoke Video Guidance

An immersive interactive setup walkthrough designed to overcome initial barriers and inspire self-expression.

Visual Walkthrough

Step-by-step interactive screen overlays showing exactly how to effortlessly capture and digitize wardrobe items.

Aesthetic Inspiration

Dynamic, high-energy montages showcasing complete styled outfits to build early excitement and trust.

Written How-To Guide

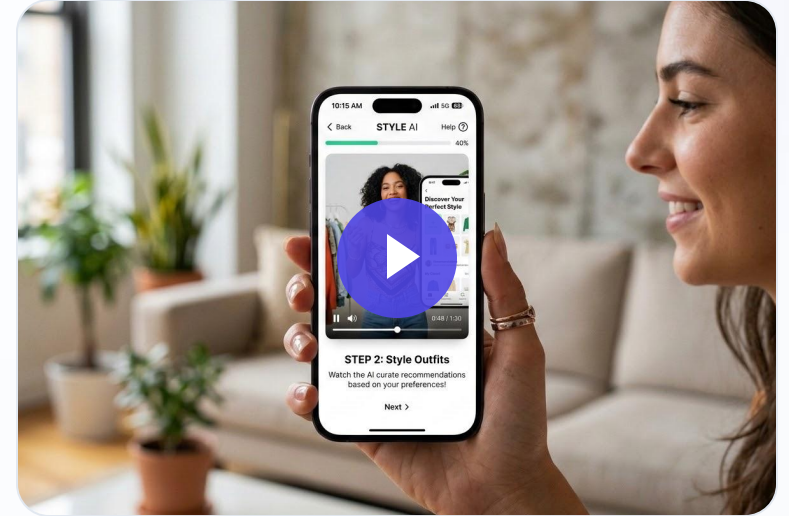
A concise, text-based manual designed for users who prefer reading and following along at their own pace.

Clear Instructions

Bite-sized, sequential instructions with bold action verbs guiding you through every screen effortlessly.

Quick Reference

Easily searchable formatting to find specific tips, troubleshooting guides, and closet organization tricks instantly.



"The interactive guide bridges physical cataloging with digital convenience, transforming early complexity into a rewarding daily habit."

■ Aligning with Alta's Core Goals



Maximize First-Time Activation

Guide users to their 1st digitized look fast. Improves clarity and boosts activation by up to **20%** (HubSpot, 2025).



Increase Feature Discovery

Prominently highlight advanced features like AI calendar sync & email receipt forwarding to drive Customer Lifetime Value.



Reduce Support Tickets

Proactively teach lighting & photo alignment to deflect up to **30%** of crop & tagging support inquiries (Gartner, 2024).



Build Habit & Brand Trust

Transform a functional digitizing utility into an intuitive, habit-forming personal stylist for daily self-expression.

■ The Software Retention Funnel

Top-Funnel Focus

Target onboarding and engagement to stop early leakage.

Overcoming Churn

Prevent drop-offs from initial setup frustration.

Path to Advocacy

Build a smooth setup that drives organic referrals.

Business Alignment

Protect long-term health via clear communication.



Structure & Visual Signposting

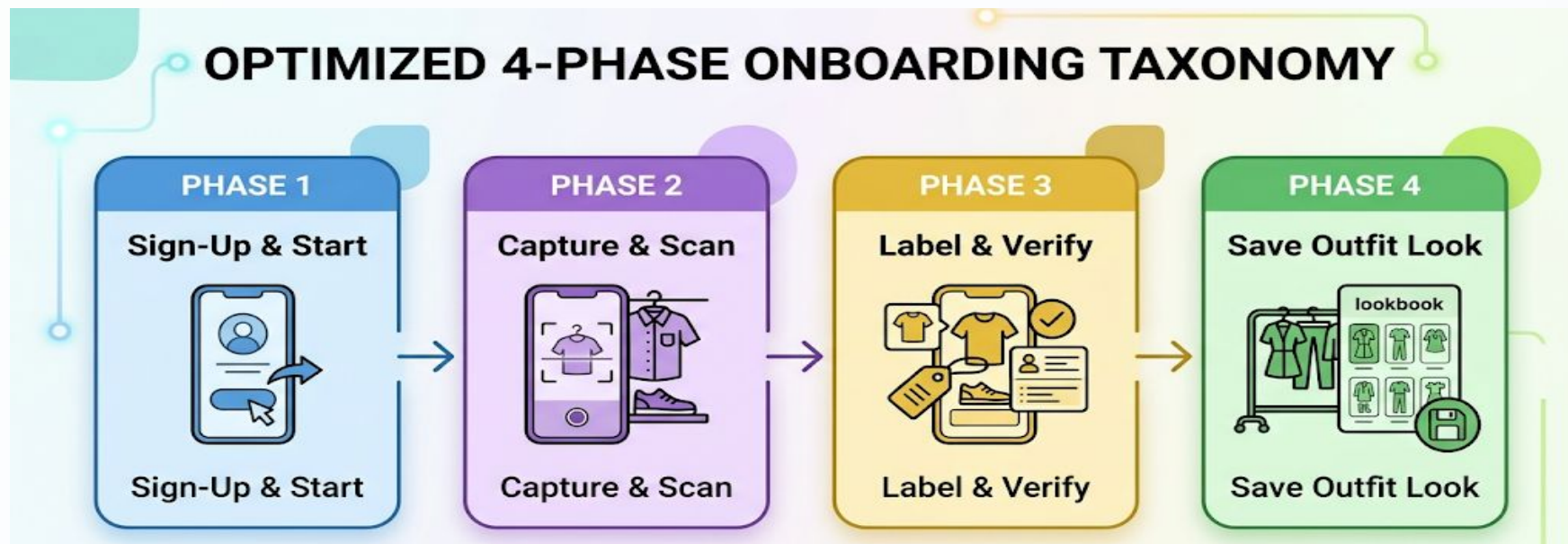
4-Phase Taxonomy

Organized chronologically to reduce cognitive load (Sweller, 1988):

1. **Phase 1:** Signing Up & Starting
2. **Phase 2:** Capturing & Digitizing
3. **Phase 3:** Labeling & Verifying
4. **Phase 4:** Creating & Saving a Look

Signposting & Scannability

- ✓ **Explicit Order Words:** "First," "Next," "Finally" bridge physical actions with digital taps.
- ✓ **8-Second Scanning Window:** Bold headers cater to digital reader habits (NN/g, 2022).
- ✓ **Upfront Document Map:** Gives immediate orientation (Markel & Selber, 2021).



Plain Language & Dual Video

Plain Language Conversion

Replacing Backend Developer Jargon (Redish, 2012):

Developer Jargon
activate render viewport



UX User Copy
open the outfit creator

Developer Jargon
generate clothing
compilation



UX User Copy
start a new look

Developer Jargon
execute file upload node



UX User Copy
tap the plus button

Dual-Channel Learning

Combines live speaker narration with app screen walkthrough (Mayer, 2009).



 creates a
personal feel

 builds trust

 jumpstarts the
process

■ 90-Day Success Metrics

+15%

Onboarding Completion

Increase in users creating their 1st look within 48 hours of download.

-25%

Support Ticket Deflection

Reduction in inbound tickets regarding photo crop & tag errors.

High

Secondary Feature Adoption

Upward trend in linking shopping emails & using AI calendar scheduling.

✔ **Summary: Measuring these KPIs proves the guide's value as both a human-centered learning tool and a high-ROI asset for business growth.**

■ Concluding with our key points



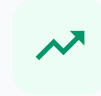
Human-Centered Design

A 4-phase, plain-language process that simplifies user setup and minimizes milestone anxiety.



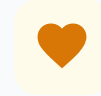
Dual-Channel Learning

Combines live speaker walkthroughs with step-by-step videos to build user trust quickly.



Proven Business ROI

Optimizes early user retention to maximize lifetime value and deflect support tickets.



Download to Advocacy

Empathetic, structured onboarding converts first-time app downloads into lifelong brand promoters.

Clear technical communication protects user retention and drives long-term business health.

Thank you for your time and feedback!



ITLS 6320



Nikaila Bell



Alta UX Strategy

References

Gartner. (2024). *Customer service and support benchmarks for digital self-service*. Gartner Research.

HubSpot. (2025). *The state of user onboarding and customer activation*. HubSpot Product Insights.

Markel, M., & Selber, S. A. (2021). *Technical communication* (13th ed.). Bedford/St. Martin's.

Mayer, R. E. (2009). *Multimedia learning* (2nd ed.). Cambridge University Press.

Nielsen Norman Group. (2022). *How users read on the web: Visual scanning patterns and attention spans*. NN/g Insights.

Redish, J. (2012). *Letting go of the words: Writing web content that works* (2nd ed.). Morgan Kaufmann.

Sweller, J. (1988). Cognitive load during problem solving: Effects on learning. *Cognitive Science*, 12(2), 257-285.

Getty Images. (n.d.). *Retention marketing funnel infographic* [Stock illustration].
<https://www.gettyimages.com/detail/illustration/2273173224>